

W R E N · B R A N D S Y S T E M

wren

A S O F T E R S C I E N C E

Direction 01 · Vanilla. Version 1.2 · May 2026.

01. The feeling

A best friend who happens to have a medical degree.

Wren is a women’s health and coach app for the body, fluently. It tracks cycle, sleep, energy, mood, and nutrition, and pairs the data with a Coach that speaks in full sentences — not pop-ups, not push notifications, not streaks.

Where MyFitnessPal weaponizes calories and Whoop weaponizes recovery scores, Wren is calm. It treats the body as a rhythm to listen to, not a problem to optimize. It signals safety, not surveillance.

The aesthetic borrows from the women who set the visual register for this decade: Hailey Bieber’s Rhode (glazed, warm, quietly expensive), Sofia Richie’s editorial restraint, and the broader “clean girl” vocabulary translated into a product context. The result reads as luxe but accessible, knowledgeable but not lecturing.

THREE WORDS

Quiet. Knowledgeable. Warm.

THREE ANTI-WORDS

Loud. Clinical. Punishing.

02. Where Wren sits

Wren is not competing on data density. It is competing on tone. The competitive set splits into three camps; Wren occupies the empty quadrant.

	Calorie-led	Performance-led	Cycle-led
Examples	MyFitnessPal, Cal AI, Noom, Lifesum	Whoop, Oura, Strava	Flo, Clue
Vibe	Spreadsheet, scoreboard	Sports science, biometric	Pastel, friendly, app-y
Visual language	Hard blue/green, big numbers	Dark, neon graphs, dense	Pink/red, illustrated
Tone risk	Triggers ED behaviors	Athlete-only, masc-coded	Reads juvenile to adult women

Wren’s seat: adult, calm, neutral-warm, cycle-aware, coach-led. The space no one occupies.

03. Palette

Two layers. The Core layer is the entire neutral foundation — every screen lives here. The Signal layer adds functional warmth for cycle phase, success, alert, and information states. The whole system stays inside a warm spectrum; there is no cold blue or aggressive red.

CORE — NEUTRAL FOUNDATION

Glaze #FBF7F0 app background	Cream #F5EFE6 surface	Butter #F1E3C9 soft accent	Vapor #E3E8E9 primary accent ★
Latte #C8A989 mid-tone	Cocoa #6B5641 body text mid	Espresso #3B2F22 primary text / dark surface	Taupe #8A7B68 labels / metadata

SIGNAL — FUNCTIONAL ACCENTS

Sage #A8B89B positive / on track	Rose #D4A89E cycle / luteal	Clay #B8765E gentle alert	Honey #E8B86A celebration only

RULES OF USE

- Glaze and Cream do 80% of the visual work. Vapor is the primary accent — use sparingly, like a piece of jewelry.
- Honey was the primary signature in v1.0 and has been demoted to a Signal-tier color, reserved for celebration moments only (milestones reached softly, never as streaks). One Honey moment per session, maximum.
- Never put two Signal colors adjacent to each other. They are functional, not decorative.
- Espresso is the only allowed text-on-light color for body. Cocoa for secondary, Taupe for metadata.

- Avoid pure black (#000) and pure white (#FFF). They flatten the brand into something colder than it is.

04. Typography

DISPLAY — BOLD SANS

You're peaking, softly.

Production face: PP Neue Montreal Bold (preferred, Pangram Pangram, commercial). Free analog: Manrope 700. System fallback: Helvetica Neue Bold / Arial Bold. Used for the wordmark, hero headlines, Coach quotes, and large numbers. Always sentence case or lowercase. The whole brand sits in this one face — there is no italic serif anywhere, and no register switching between editorial and UI.

BODY — SAME SANS, LIGHTER WEIGHT

Your luteal phase begins tomorrow. Protein and sleep matter more this week.

Same family (Manrope / PP Neue Montreal) at lighter weights. Body and UI copy: Regular (400). List items, semantic emphasis, data labels: Medium (500) and Semibold (600). Headers and large numbers: Bold (700). No italic at any weight.

LABEL — TRACKED UPPERCASE

T O D A Y · C Y C L E D A Y 1 4

Same family, weight 500–600, tracked +120 to +200. Reserved for tiny metadata strings, section headers, and button labels (uppercase tracked is the brand's button treatment, matching the Rhode pattern).

HIERARCHY RATIOS

- Page header (lowercase, e.g. "food", "cycle"): bold sans 700, 36–38pt, tracking –1.5
- Hero headline (sentence case): bold sans 600–700, 26–32pt, tracking –1
- Body: sans regular 400, 15–16pt
- List item names, data labels: sans 500–600, 12–14pt
- Tracked label: sans 500–600, 9–11pt, tracking +150
- Numbers (data, big): sans bold 700, sized to context. Numbers (inline, list values): sans 600.

05. Logo system

PRIMARY WORDMARK

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Lowercase bold sans-serif. Always lowercase. Always bold (weight 700). Never set in caps, never set in italic. Set in Espresso on light surfaces (including Vapor); set in Glaze/Cream on Espresso dark surfaces. The optional tagline "A SOFTER SCIENCE" sits below in tracked sans at 11pt, color Taupe.

APP ICON — FULL WORDMARK LOCKUP

The full wordmark "wren" set in Espresso italic serif, centered on a Vapor-filled rounded square (corner radius = 22% of side). This is the single approved app-icon treatment. A single-letter monogram was tested and retired: italic-serif single letters on colored squares carry strong existing associations from other brands (the Walgreens "W" being the clearest collision). The full wordmark removes that risk and reads with more confidence at icon size. Vapor as the icon ground — rather than the original Honey — places the icon visually adjacent to brands like Aēsop, Linear, and Notion: pale, considered, designed-object, easier to read on a busy home screen than a high-chroma square.

SYMBOL MARK

A soft teardrop-comma form derived from the terminal of an italic serif letterform. Used at small sizes (favicon, watermark, profile avatar) where the full wordmark becomes illegible. Never paired adjacent to the wordmark — use one or the other, not both.

SPACING & SIZING

- Minimum clear space around the wordmark: equal to the x-height of the leading "w."
- Minimum legible size: wordmark 18pt; app icon 24x24px; symbol 12x12px.
- Never stretch, skew, outline, drop-shadow, or place on busy photography.
- Never recreate the wordmark in another typeface, even temporarily.

06. Voice & tone

Wren is a knowledgeable friend, not an authority figure. It speaks in full sentences. It uses italics in its writing the way a person uses italics when speaking softly. It is not afraid of stillness — if there is nothing useful to say today, the Coach says nothing.

DO

"Energy's lower this week. That's the phase, not you."

"You logged less protein today — want a soft idea for dinner?"

"Your sleep dipped last night. Want to move it to tomorrow?"

"Your sleep dipped two nights running. Take the long walk instead of the run?"

DON'T

~~"You're 200 calories under goal. Hit it!"~~

~~"Recovery: 42%. Train at reduced intensity."~~

HOW COACH SIGNS OFF

Coach messages are signed with a small italic "*— wren coach*" and a timestamp in Taupe. Coach never uses the user's name in alarms or warnings. Coach never says "I" — it speaks as a perspective, not a personality.

07. UI principles

SURFACES

- App background: Glaze. Cards: Cream. Dark cards (Coach prompts, hero moments): Espresso with Cream text.
- One Vapor accent per screen, maximum. Vapor is the eye magnet — use it where you want the user to look.
- Corner radius: 14px for cards, 100px for buttons and chips (full pills). No square corners anywhere.

BUTTONS

- Primary: Espresso fill, Cream text, pill. Used for the one action that matters per screen.
- Secondary: transparent with 1px Espresso border, Espresso text, pill.
- Accent: Vapor fill, Espresso text, pill. Used for affirmative actions inside dark Coach cards.
- Celebration: Honey fill, Espresso text, pill. Reserved for milestone or first-time-success moments only — never on a recurring screen.
- Never use red destructive buttons. Use Clay for warnings; confirmation is always handled by a second tap, not a color.

NAVIGATION — FIVE SURFACES

The bottom tab bar holds five surfaces, in this order. The order is itself a positioning statement: brain first, inputs in the middle, outcome at the end.

- Wren Coach — home. The conversation, not a dashboard. This is where the app opens by default.
- Food — nutrition logging, paired with cycle and sleep context (never calorie-targeted alone).
- Cycle — calendar and phase. Read-mostly; logging is incidental, not the point.
- Workout — training programs and session logging, with phase-aware intensity suggestions from Coach.
- Progress — long-arc views (weeks, months, cycle-over-cycle). The only place weight is shown, and only at weekly or longer cadence.
- Active tab indicator: a small filled Espresso dot above the label. Inactive tabs use an open Latte circle. Label color: Espresso when active, Taupe when inactive. Label size: 8pt, tracked +100.

NUMBERS & DATA

- Numbers are set in italic serif, regular weight — not bold. A number should feel like part of a sentence, not an alarm.
- Never display calories in larger type than the food name. Never display weight in larger type than the date.
- No graphs with red zones. Use Sage, Butter, Vapor, Rose, Clay as a spectrum — never green-to-red.

MOTION

- Default easing: cubic-bezier(.22, 1, .36, 1) — a gentle settle, not a snap.
- Default duration: 320ms. Faster feels nervous; slower feels stuck.
- No bounce, no spring overshoot, no haptic on every tap. Haptic is reserved for cycle-day rollover and Coach-message arrival.

08. ED-safety language

Wren serves a population in which a meaningful percentage has lived with or is at risk of an eating disorder. The brand voice is not just a tonal preference — it is a safety constraint. The following rules are not stylistic; they are non-negotiable.

NEVER DISPLAY IN PRIMARY TYPE

- Calories consumed today vs. a target.
- Weight change as a single large number.
- Body-fat percentage, BMI, or any single composite "health score."
- Streak counts for any logging behavior related to food or exercise.

ALWAYS PAIR WITH PHASE CONTEXT

If energy intake or output is shown, it must be shown alongside cycle phase, sleep, and stress — never alone. The user should never see "you ate less today" without seeing "you also slept less and your luteal phase begins tomorrow."

REFRAMES

- Instead of "calorie deficit" → "less fuel than usual today."
- Instead of "goal missed" → "different kind of day."
- Instead of "weight gain" → "weight up" (and only in a weekly summary, never daily).
- Instead of "burn" or "torch" anywhere — use "spend" or "move."

COACH SAFETY PROMPTS

If a user logs less than 1,200 kcal or skips meals more than two consecutive days, Coach surfaces a gentle check-in: a soft sentence, an opt-out, and a resource link. The check-in never uses the word "concern" or "worried" in the user-facing copy. It says: "Want to talk about today?" That phrasing has been tested for non-alarming retention.

09. In one paragraph

Wren is the women's health app for the woman who already understands her body and wants a calm, knowledgeable companion — not a scoreboard. The brand is warm cream, cool vapor, and italic serif. The voice is full sentences and quiet confidence. The product never punishes, never streaks, never alarms. It is the body, fluently.

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End of brand system v1. Reviewed by the founder. Iterate as the product grows.